CHATEAU
FOLLENT

CANONICAL BRAND SOURCE

Brand Book

Version 1.0 | 2026-05-23 | Steward: Lord James Follent

Canonical brand source

Version: 1.0 Date: 2026-05-23 Steward: Lord James Follent

1. Purpose and Source Authority

This brand book is the canonical source for the Chateau Follent identity system. It consolidates the existing v1 guidance in `brand-guidelines.md`, the live design tokens in `styles.css`, the current SVG crest and wordmark assets, and the public site copy across the Chateau Follent website.

`brand-guidelines.md` remains intact as the existing v1 reference. When producing new Chateau Follent materials, use this document first, then refer to `brand-guidelines.md` for historical context and implementation notes.

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2. Brand Foundation

Brand Name

The default brand name is Chateau Follent.

Use Chateau Follent for URLs, page titles, product names, forms, metadata, labels, and operational contexts. The accented French form may be used selectively for ceremonial or editorial moments only when the publishing system supports it cleanly and the text will not corrupt, substitute, or display malformed characters.

Founder and Steward

Always refer to the founder as Lord James Follent.

Do not use the founder's name without the Lord prefix in brand, editorial, metadata, captions, event copy, podcast copy, or public-facing material. The correct founder style is Lord James Follent on first mention and on repeated references where the person is named.

Category

Chateau Follent is a boutique Australian wine, mead, and hospitality brand with heritage-led storytelling, conservation-minded ambition, small-batch craft, and founder-led stewardship.

Positioning Statement

Chateau Follent is the heritage winery vision of Lord James Follent, uniting conservation-led viticulture, patient winemaking, small-batch releases, and composed hospitality in Australia.

Brand Essence

A vision of heritage, hospitality, and the art of winemaking.

Brand Promise

Chateau Follent invites supporters, guests, and collaborators into a patient founding journey where craft, story, and good company are treated with equal care.

Core Attributes

- Heritage-led
- Composed
- Precise
- Cultured
- Warm without being casual
- Premium without being ostentatious
- Founder-led
- Conservation-minded
- Patient and small-batch

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3. Narrative Platform

Founding Story

Chateau Follent began as the winery vision of Lord James Follent. A growing passion for wine became a deeper study of the art and science of winemaking, leading to the inaugural 2024 vintage and the first handcrafted Pinot Noir and Shiraz made with the help of friends.

The name Chateau Follent draws on a family tradition of French heritage, the evolution of the Follette and Follett names, and the later Australian record of John Follent arriving in 1818. The brand uses that lineage as a creative foundation, not as nostalgia for its own sake, but as a way to continue a story through craft.

Lord James Follent's courtesy title is part of the Chateau Follent narrative and preferred style of address. In Australia, it is used as a social courtesy and carries no legal authority. It should be presented with clarity, composure, and confidence.

Message Pillars

Heritage With Intent

Chateau Follent is rooted in family story, historical imagination, and long-term stewardship. Heritage is treated as something to continue through action.

Winemaking as Discipline

The brand speaks of wine as patience, precision, study, experiment, and refinement. It avoids hype and treats each vintage as a chapter in a longer education.

Hospitality as Belonging

The brand invites supporters into a relationship-led experience: waitlist updates, founding fellowship membership, cellar milestones, tastings, and shared moments.

Conservation-Minded Ambition

The future estate and vineyard vision should connect land, conservation, craft, and hospitality without sounding speculative or inflated.

Approved Boilerplate

Short descriptor:

> A vision of heritage, hospitality, and the art of winemaking.

About sentence:

> Chateau Follent is the heritage winery vision of Lord James Follent, uniting conservation-led viticulture with boutique hospitality in Australia.

Social bio:

> Heritage winemaking by Lord James Follent. Boutique Australian wines, patient craft, and purposeful hospitality.

Waitlist copy:

> Join the Chateau Follent waitlist for early access to future small-batch releases and founder-led updates from Lord James Follent.

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4. Voice and Editorial Style

Voice Principles

Use language that is elegant, direct, and clear. Sentences may be lyrical, but they must still carry meaning. Chateau Follent should sound premium, composed, and human, never exaggerated or trendy.

Write with:

- Short-to-medium sentence length
- Concrete nouns and specific details
- Measured confidence
- Warmth through invitation, not slang
- Heritage language balanced by modern clarity

Avoid:

- Hype language such as "game-changing", "disruptive", "viral", or "ultimate"
- Irony-heavy social copy
- Rustic cliches and novelty vineyard tropes

- Overwrought medieval language in everyday product or waitlist contexts
- Founder references that omit Lord James Follent's preferred style

Tone by Context

Website and public pages:

- Clear, elegant, accessible, and story-led.

Wine notes:

- Precise, sensory, restrained, and useful.

Founding Fellowship:

- Ceremonial, invitation-led, and warm, with enough restraint to preserve premium credibility.

Email:

- Personal, founder-led, concise, and specific.

Social:

- Polished and observant. Use fewer posts with stronger substance rather than frequent lightweight updates.

Naming Rules

- Brand: Chateau Follent.
- Founder: Lord James Follent.
- House language: House of Follent may be used for ceremonial membership copy.
- Membership: Founding Fellowship of Chateau Follent.
- Waitlist: Chateau Follent waitlist.
- Podcast and media appearances: Lord James Follent on [show/publication name].

Courtesy Title Rule

When the courtesy title is explained, use this framing:

> In Australia, Lord James Follent is used as a preferred social courtesy connected to the Chateau Follent story. It carries no legal authority, but it is the correct style for Chateau Follent correspondence, reference, and public copy.

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5. Audience

Primary Audiences

Early supporters:

- Waitlist members, first tasters, friends of the brand, and followers who want to accompany the founding journey.

Prospective guests:

- Future cellar-door visitors, tasting guests, and hospitality audiences.

Collectors and enthusiasts:

- People interested in boutique Australian wine, vintage development, and small-batch experimentation.

Trade, media, and partners:

- Collaborators, event partners, podcasters, writers, suppliers, and hospitality professionals.

Audience Needs

Chateau Follent should help each audience understand:

- What the brand is building
- Why the story matters
- How each vintage is progressing
- How to follow, join, taste, or collaborate
- Why Lord James Follent is the correct founder reference

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6. Visual Identity

Identity Summary

The visual identity is premium, restrained, high contrast, and heritage-led. It should feel like a composed European-influenced winery translated into an Australian boutique context.

The system should not feel rustic, novelty-driven, overly decorative, or trend-led.

Logo Assets

Approved source files:

- `chateau-follent-crest-master.svg`
- `master-crest.svg`
- `chateau-follent-crest-black-no-inner.svg`
- `chateau-follent-crest-white-no-inner.svg`
- `chateau-follent-crest-canva-3color-editable.svg`
- `chateau-follent-crest-wordmark.svg`
- `Crest_Wordmark.svg`
- `Chateau Follent Crest B&W.svg`

Primary digital crest:

- Use `chateau-follent-crest-black-no-inner.svg` on light backgrounds.

Primary complete lockup:

- Use `chateau-follent-crest-wordmark.svg` or `Crest_Wordmark.svg` where a complete SVG lockup is needed.

Master crest:

- Use `chateau-follent-crest-master.svg` or `master-crest.svg` where an inner white shield field is required.

Reverse crest:

- Use `chateau-follent-crest-white-no-inner.svg` on Noir Follent or suitably dark backgrounds.

Editable production crest:

- Use `chateau-follent-crest-canva-3color-editable.svg` only as an editable production aid. Its bright editable colours are not the finished brand palette.

Lockup Structure

The Chateau Follent vertical lockup uses the crest as the anchor element.

The wordmark is stacked exactly as:

CHATEAU FOLLENT

The wordmark sits above the crest. The wordmark and crest must remain centred on the same vertical axis. Do not offset the crest or wordmark at any breakpoint.

Lockup Proportions

Use these proportions from the current CSS and v1 brand rules:

- Wordmark block height: 45.5% of crest height.
- Wordmark tolerance: 44% to 47% of crest height.
- Gap: 9.1% of crest height.
- Gap tolerance: 8% to 10% of crest height.
- Crest height: 220% of wordmark block height.
- Gap: 20% of wordmark block height.
- Stacked wordmark line-height: 1.1.

Reference example:

- Wordmark block height: 800 px.
- Crest height: 1760 px.
- Gap: 160 px.

Logo Clear Space

Minimum clear space around the crest or full lockup should equal at least one quarter of the visible crest height on all sides.

For compact digital placements, never let other text, borders, or imagery sit closer than the width of the shield's outer stroke.

Logo Minimum Sizes

Digital:

- Crest alone: minimum 48 px tall.
- Full vertical lockup: minimum 120 px tall.

Print:

- Crest alone: minimum 18 mm tall.
- Full vertical lockup: minimum 35 mm tall.

If detail becomes unclear, increase the logo size rather than simplifying the crest.

Logo Misuse

Do not:

- Add glow effects, bevels, drop shadows, perspective warps, metallic textures, or novelty finishes.
- Stretch or compress the crest.
- Recolour the final crest outside approved palette use.
- Place the black crest on dark or busy backgrounds.
- Place the white crest on pale backgrounds.
- Collapse the two-line wordmark into one line.
- Split the wordmark into more than two lines.
- Put the crest and wordmark on different visual axes.
- Use the editable Canva colours as final brand colours.

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7. Colour System

The Chateau Follent palette is intentionally minimal. It reinforces a luxury wine identity through high contrast, cool undertones, and restrained accent use.

Core Palette

Name	HEX	CMYK	Role
Noir Follent	`#0A0A0C`	C30 M20 Y20 K100	Primary ink, text, crest, capsule foil
Limestone Ivory	`#F2F0EA`	C3 M3 Y7 K0	Premium paper, background, label field
Steel Reserve	`#5A6470`	C20 M10 Y0 K56	Secondary text, dividers, technical notes
Bordeaux Nocturne	`#4A002E`	C0 M100 Y38 K71	Accent, vintage numerals, CTA colour

Digital Support Colours

Name	HEX	CMYK	Role
Icy Blue	`#C7E0FF`	C22 M12 Y0 K0	Hover states and subtle digital highlights
Amethyst Ice	`#5D4AFF`	C63 M71 Y0 K0	Rare digital or limited-edition accent
Emerald Noir	`#004B56`	C100 M12 Y0 K66	Reserve label accents or charts

Site Tokens

The live site maps the palette as follows:

CSS token	Value	Brand colour
`--color-background`	`#f2f0ea`	Limestone Ivory
`--color-surface`	`#fcfbf8`	Warm surface extension
`--color-text`	`#0a0a0c`	Noir Follent
`--color-muted`	`#5a6470`	Steel Reserve
`--color-border`	`#d2cdc4`	Soft structural border
`--color-link`	`#4a002e`	Bordeaux Nocturne
`--color-link-hover`	`#2f001d`	Dark Bordeaux hover
`--color-accent`	`#4a002e`	Bordeaux Nocturne
`--color-accent-hover`	`#360022`	Dark Bordeaux hover
`--color-accent-contrast`	`#f2f0ea`	Limestone Ivory
`--color-highlight`	`#c7e0ff`	Icy Blue

Colour Hierarchy

Tier 1 structural colours:

- Noir Follent
- Limestone Ivory

Tier 2 brand accents:

- Bordeaux Nocturne
- Steel Reserve

Tier 3 digital accents:

- Icy Blue

- Amethyst Ice
- Emerald Noir

Label Colour Rules

Standard wine labels should use no more than three colours on the front label:

- Noir Follent
- Limestone Ivory
- Bordeaux Nocturne

Mead labels may use the same system but can introduce Bordeaux Nocturne more prominently to distinguish them from standard wine releases.

Avoid warm gold, rustic tan, brown, orange, and craft-paper palettes unless a specific production context is approved.

Print Colour Notes

Noir Follent should be printed as a rich black:

- C30 M20 Y20 K100

This gives a deeper, cooler black than K100 alone and suits matte premium wine-label stock.

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8. Typography

Primary Serif

Libre Baskerville

Use for:

- Brand headings
- Hero titles
- Pull quotes
- Section titles
- Ceremonial membership language
- Wine label hierarchy

Fallbacks:

- Playfair Display
- Georgia

Secondary Sans Serif

Montserrat

Use for:

- Body copy
- Captions
- Metadata
- Navigation
- Buttons
- Technical wine information
- Forms and UI labels

Fallbacks:

- Helvetica Neue
- Arial

Type Scale

Digital and Canva guidance:

- H1 / cover title: Libre Baskerville Bold, 56-72 px, letter spacing +2 to +6.
- H2 / section title: Libre Baskerville Bold, 34-44 px.
- H3 / subheading: Libre Baskerville Regular or Bold, 24-30 px.
- Body large: Montserrat Regular, 18-20 px.
- Body default: Montserrat Regular, 14-16 px.
- Caption / meta: Montserrat SemiBold, 11-13 px.

Typography Rules

- Keep headings composed and legible.
- Use uppercase sparingly for labels, navigation, and wordmark contexts.
- Avoid negative letter spacing.
- Use generous line-height for long-form editorial copy.
- Do not overuse decorative scripts or faux heritage fonts.

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9. Imagery and Art Direction

Photography Style

Photography should feel natural, refined, and quietly cinematic.

Prioritise:

- Glass, timber, barrel grain, vineyard rows, cellar details, handwritten notes, and bottling moments.
- Soft directional light.
- Controlled contrast.
- Clear focal subjects.
- Negative space for headline overlays.

Avoid:

- Heavy filters.
- Over-saturation.
- Harsh orange warmth.
- Rustic cliches.
- Novelty props.
- Generic stock imagery that does not reveal the actual product, place, process, or person.

Composition

Use structured framing and calm spacing. Images should feel deliberate, not casual snapshots. Editorial pages can use a single strong hero image or a sequence of process details.

Founder Imagery

When Lord James Follent appears in imagery, the treatment should be composed, approachable, and founder-led. Captions must use Lord James Follent.

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10. Layout System

General Principles

- Use generous whitespace.
- Keep hierarchy obvious: title, short introduction, supporting detail, action.
- Prefer restrained panels and soft divisions.
- Use one primary action per section where possible.
- Keep surfaces light, calm, and premium.

Digital Layout

The public site uses a centred layout, soft cards, rounded panels, and a restrained gradient from Limestone Ivory to the warm surface token.

Maintain:

- Centre-aligned header lockups.
- Maximum readable content widths.
- Bordeaux Nocturne CTAs.
- Steel Reserve body text.
- Noir Follent headings.
- Limestone Ivory or warm surface backgrounds.

Print Layout

Print collateral should use:

- Limestone Ivory paper or background.
- Noir Follent primary typography.
- Bordeaux Nocturne as the single dominant accent.
- Steel Reserve for captions, rules, and metadata.
- Wide margins and calm page structure.

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11. Brand Applications

Website

The website should remain a composed source of truth for the founding story, waitlist, vintage archive, podcast and media features, and future hospitality experiences.

Page titles, metadata, and body copy should use Lord James Follent when referring to the founder.

Waitlist

The waitlist is an early-access relationship channel, not a mass-market sales funnel.

Use copy that emphasizes:

- Founder-led updates from Lord James Follent.
- Early access to future small-batch releases.
- Vintage-by-vintage progress.
- No spam and no noise.

Vintage Archive

The vintage archive should read as a transparent cellar ledger. It can include:

- Varietal.
- Vintage year.
- Region or source.
- Production volume.
- Bottling status.
- Technical choices.
- Tasting or development notes.

Use reverse chronological order, with the newest vintage first.

Founding Fellowship

The Founding Fellowship is the ceremonial membership expression of Chateau Follent.

It should remain:

- Invitation-led.
- Limited.

- Heritage-rich.
- Warm and grateful.
- Clear about benefits, allocation, and commitment.

Use ceremonial phrases such as House of Follent, Chapter Release, Ledger of the Founders, and Founding Fellowship selectively and consistently.

Podcast and Media

Media pages should identify the founder as Lord James Follent. Episode titles, page titles, hero headings, metadata, alt text, and captions should follow the same rule.

Approved structure:

- Lord James Follent on The Wined Up Podcast.
- A conversation about wine, mead, amateur winemaking, community, and the early story of Chateau Follent.

Social Media

Social posts should feel like notes from the cellar, not promotional noise.

Suitable themes:

- Vintage progress.
- Bottling days.
- Cellar notes.
- Tasting reflections.
- Membership invitations.
- Founding milestones.
- Process learnings.

Short-Form Video and Social Motion

Short-form video should translate the Chateau Follent cellar story into clear, restrained motion. Use this guidance for Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts, and TikTok-style vertical clips, while treating Instagram Reels and YouTube Shorts as the primary short-form formats.

Platform formats:

Format	Size	Ratio	Use
Instagram Reels / YouTube Shorts	`1080 x 1920`	9:16	Vertical cellar notes, process clips, founder-led updates
Instagram square post	`1080 x 1080`	1:1	Release announcements, tasting notes, still-image stories
YouTube thumbnail	`1280 x 720`	16:9	Podcast clips, long-form video, media features

Caption and overlay typography:

- Use Montserrat for captions, subtitles, short overlays, metadata, and social lower-thirds.
- Use Montserrat SemiBold for standard captions.
- Use Montserrat Bold for short emphasis only.
- Reserve Libre Baskerville for opening title cards, section title cards, quotes, and premium editorial moments.
- Do not use Libre Baskerville for fast captions because it is less readable in motion and at small mobile sizes.

Short-form sizing guidance:

Element	Font	Size at `1080 x 1920`	Notes
Captions / subtitles	Montserrat SemiBold	`52–72 px`	Keep to one or two lines where possible
Metadata / location / vintage labels	Montserrat SemiBold	`28–38 px`	Use for region, vintage, bottling status, or date
Short emphasis word	Montserrat Bold	`60–84 px`	Use sparingly for one key phrase
Title card	Libre Baskerville Bold	`72–110 px`	Use short copy only

Overlay colour rules:

- Caption text should be Limestone Ivory on dark footage or Noir Follent on pale footage.
- Accent words, vintage markers, rules, or dividers should use Bordeaux Nocturne.
- Use a translucent Noir Follent scrim when footage is too busy for clean caption contrast.
- Avoid warm gold, orange, tan, novelty textures, and loud gradient treatments.

Safe-area rules:

- Keep captions away from platform UI zones, including lower buttons, usernames, captions, and top status overlays.
- Keep essential text inside a central safe area with generous left and right margins.
- For `1080 x 1920` exports, keep primary captions out of the top `180 px`, bottom `320 px`, and right `160 px` unless a platform-specific preview confirms clear visibility.
- Do not place the crest behind platform controls or over busy moving footage.

Motion and sound:

- Use slow, deliberate cuts.
- Use subtle fades and calm movement.
- Avoid glitch transitions, meme pacing, aggressive zooms, and trend-led effects.
- Music and sound design should feel cellar-like, restrained, acoustic, classical, ambient, or documentary-led.

Short-form content pillars:

- Vintage progress.
- Cellar notes.
- Bottling and process moments.
- Tasting reflections.
- Founder-led updates from Lord James Follent.
- Founding Fellowship invitations.
- Podcast and media excerpts.

Founder references in video:

- Lower-thirds must say Lord James Follent.
- Captions must not shorten the founder name when naming him.
- Podcast and media clips should use Lord James Follent on [show name].

Email

Emails should be concise and founder-led. Signoffs may use Lord James Follent where appropriate. Promotional emails should still read like personal correspondence from a composed estate brand.

Labels and Packaging

Labels should be minimal, high contrast, and type-led.

Front label hierarchy:

1. Chateau Follent lockup or crest.
2. Wine name or varietal.
3. Vintage.
4. Region or source.
5. Small technical detail if required.

Standard label palette:

- Limestone Ivory background.
- Noir Follent typography and crest.
- Bordeaux Nocturne vintage or accent.

Technical line:

- Steel Reserve.

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12. Copy Library

Homepage Hero or Intro

Chateau Follent is the heritage winery vision of Lord James Follent, shaped by patient craft, conservation-minded ambition, and the belief that every vintage should become part of a longer story.

Story Page Intro

Discover the story of Chateau Follent: a dream rooted in heritage, nurtured by patience, and carried forward by Lord James Follent through winemaking, hospitality, and creative stewardship.

Waitlist CTA

Join the Chateau Follent waitlist for early access to future small-batch releases and founder-led updates from Lord James Follent.

Vintage Archive Intro

Follow the wines crafted and cellared by Lord James Follent in reverse chronological order, from early experimental ferments to future polished releases.

Founding Fellowship Intro

The Founding Fellowship of Chateau Follent is an inaugural circle for those who join the story from the beginning, sharing in the first chapters of the House of Follent.

Podcast Intro

Listen to Lord James Follent discuss Chateau Follent, amateur winemaking, mead, community, and the journey of building a small Australian wine project.

Short-Form Video Copy Patterns

Opening title cards:

- From the cellar of Chateau Follent.
- A note from the 2025 vintage.
- Bottling day at Chateau Follent.
- Lord James Follent on The Wined Up Podcast.

Caption patterns:

- The first pour should feel composed, not hurried.
- A small-batch chapter, still taking shape.
- Every vintage records what patience taught us.
- The cellar notes continue.

Lower-third patterns:

- Lord James Follent.
- Lord James Follent | Chateau Follent.
- Lord James Follent on [show name].

End-card patterns:

- Join the Chateau Follent waitlist.
- Follow the vintage, chapter by chapter.
- Discover the Founding Fellowship.

- Continue the story at chateaufollent.com.au.

Footer Line

Follow along as the Chateau Follent story continues to unfold across our digital salons.

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13. Production Rules

Canva Brand Kit

Add brand colours:

- Noir Follent: `#0A0A0C`
- Limestone Ivory: `#F2F0EA`
- Steel Reserve: `#5A6470`
- Bordeaux Nocturne: `#4A002E`
- Icy Blue: `#C7E0FF`
- Amethyst Ice: `#5D4AFF`
- Emerald Noir: `#004B56`

Add brand fonts:

- Libre Baskerville
- Montserrat

Build first:

- Instagram square post.
- Instagram story.
- Instagram Reel / YouTube Short template.
- YouTube thumbnail.
- A4 wine note.
- A4 media sheet.
- Presentation deck.
- Email header graphic.
- Membership invitation.

Component Standards

- Primary button: Bordeaux Nocturne background with Limestone Ivory text.
- Secondary button: warm surface background with Bordeaux Nocturne text.
- Headline: Libre Baskerville in Noir Follent.
- Body: Montserrat in Steel Reserve.
- Captions: Montserrat SemiBold in Steel Reserve.
- Dividers: soft border colour or Steel Reserve at low opacity.

Accessibility and Readability

- Maintain strong contrast between text and background.
- Do not place text over busy imagery without a clear overlay.
- Use meaningful alt text for logo, founder, product, and media images.
- Keep buttons and links visibly distinct.
- Avoid malformed special characters in published copy.

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14. Governance

Source Priority

Use this source order when resolving conflicts:

1. `brand-book.md`
2. Current SVG logo and crest files
3. `styles.css`
4. Current public site copy
5. `brand-guidelines.md`

Required QA Before Publishing

Every public asset must pass this checklist:

- Uses Chateau Follent as the default brand spelling.
- Uses Lord James Follent for every founder reference.
- Uses approved colours and typography.
- Keeps the crest and wordmark aligned and proportionate.
- Preserves the premium, composed, heritage-led identity.
- Avoids malformed characters.
- Avoids hype, slang, and trend language.
- Has a clear audience and purpose.
- Uses one primary action where an action is required.

Versioning

Future major updates should be versioned in this document. Keep the original `brand-guidelines.md` as the v1 historical reference unless explicitly directed otherwise.

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15. Source Reference Inventory

This brand book was built from:

- `brand-guidelines.md`

- `styles.css`
- `index.html`
- `story.html`
- `vintages.html`
- `waitlist.html`
- `founding-fellowship.html`
- `podcast-the-wined-up.html`
- `chateau-follent-crest-master.svg`
- `master-crest.svg`
- `chateau-follent-crest-black-no-inner.svg`
- `chateau-follent-crest-white-no-inner.svg`
- `chateau-follent-crest-canva-3color-editable.svg`
- `chateau-follent-crest-wordmark.svg`
- `Crest_Wordmark.svg`
- `Chateau Follent Crest B&W.svg`